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To start, I would like to talk about the “culture shock” I experienced when I transferred to JRU. I came from Mapua University, and due to personal reasons, transferred to JRU after a semester gap (6 months of no school). Around this time, I had already forgotten my past Java lessons. Being a late enrollee, I was also absent during the first day of classes which caused me to miss important instructions on what to do in Dr. Arlene Valderama’s class. I had to catch up and reread my previous notes from Mapua in order to get up to speed. I did not know her teaching style at that time, so I had to feel my way through her class. One day, she called me to recite, and my notes were wrong which led to my answer being wrong as well. She called me out on it, telling me I should listen closely and write down notes more precisely. From that moment on, I swore to myself that I would be at my best during my classes to make up for the 6 months that I was on break. I wrote down notes, I read them, I practiced when I had the time to, and I used outside sources to review like W3Schools.

Ultimately, I think the prelims for me was an eye-opener on how laid back I used to be during my first year in Mapua. I learned to be more responsible with my time management and my note-taking abilities. Writing or typing during lessons actually helped me absorb the lessons because I was writing what I understood, not what I heard. From that point on, it was all simply logic.